

2022-annual-report

Apoti Development Association (ADA)

Annual Report 2022

Love, Respect & Service

"We love because He first loved us." — 1 John 4:19

Our First Full Year of Impact

7 Projects | 140 Beneficiaries | 2 Cities | 4 Demographics

Apoti Development Association Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
www.apotidev.org

Message from the Founder

Dear friends, partners, and supporters,

When we registered ADA in November 2021, we were three volunteers visiting widows in their homes with food baskets and prayer. We had no office, no budget, and no formal programs — just a conviction that God was calling us to serve the most vulnerable in our communities.

Twelve months later, I am humbled to present this report documenting what God accomplished through this small team in 2022: **seven projects delivered, 140 lives touched, expansion to a second city, and the launch of our first vocational training program.**

The growth has been extraordinary. From three widows receiving home visits, we scaled to organized programs serving widows, orphans, internally displaced girls, and the broader community. Our team grew from 3 to 8+ dedicated volunteers. We opened operations in Bamenda alongside our Buea headquarters. We delivered a project nearly every month.

But the numbers only tell part of the story. Behind each statistic is a widow who learned tailoring and now feeds her children through her own labor. A displaced teenage girl who received baking training and a startup kit to build a small business. An orphan who returned to school with supplies and the knowledge that someone believes in their future.

We operated with discipline — spending \$7,442 against a \$7,700 budget, delivering 3.3% under budget while reaching every beneficiary we targeted. This fiscal responsibility reflects our commitment to honoring every franc entrusted to us.

2022 proved that ADA's model works: faith-driven service, community-rooted programs, and disciplined execution. We enter 2023 with momentum, experience, and a clear vision for scaling our impact.

Thank you for believing in this mission before there was evidence. The evidence is now here.

In service,

Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc Founder & President Apoti Development Association

About ADA

Who We Are

Apoti Development Association (ADA) is a faith-based non-profit organization empowering vulnerable communities in Cameroon. Founded in November 2021 and legally registered under **N° 415/G.37/D14/VolII/SAAJ**, ADA operates from its headquarters in Buea, South-West Region, with a second office in Bamenda, North-West Region.

Our Mission

To shine the light of Jesus Christ by empowering vulnerable communities — widows, orphans, and young women — through sustainable programs that restore dignity and create opportunity.

Our Vision

A Cameroon where no widow goes hungry, no orphan is denied education, and no young woman lacks the skills to build her future.

Our Values

- **Love** — Every program begins with genuine compassion for those we serve
- **Respect** — We honor the dignity of every beneficiary, treating them as partners in their own transformation
- **Service** — We exist to serve, not to be served

Our Motto

Love, Respect & Service (1 John 4:8)

Leadership

Role	Name
Founder & President	Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc
Country Director	Naomi Ndababonga

Registration & Legal Status

- **Registration Number:** N° 415/G.37/D14/Voll/SAAJP
 - **Type:** Non-profit association
 - **Jurisdiction:** Republic of Cameroon
 - **Date of Registration:** November 2021
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2022 at a Glance

Metric	Result
 Projects Delivered	7
 Total Beneficiaries	140
 Total Expenditure	\$7,442 (4,465,000 CFA)
 Cities of Operation	2 (Buea & Bamenda)
 Demographics Served	4 (Widows, Orphans, IDPs, Community)
 Team Members	8+ volunteers (up from 3)
 Budget Efficiency	96.7% (3.3% under budget)
 Frequency	Nearly 1 project per month

Key Milestones

-  First vocational training program launched (6-month tailoring cohort)
-  First IDP-focused program delivered (baking training + startup kits)
-  Geographic expansion to Bamenda, North-West Region
-  First annual Christmas campaign established
-  Team tripled from 3 to 8+ volunteers
-  80% graduation rate in vocational training (12 of 15 participants)

Year in Review — Project Summaries

1. School Supply Distribution — February 2022

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 20 orphans | **Actual Cost:** \$467 (280,000 CFA)

ADA's first project of 2022 provided school supplies to 20 orphans in Buea at the start of the academic term. Each child received exercise books, pens, pencils, mathematical sets, and school bags. This intervention removed a critical barrier to education for children whose guardians could not afford basic supplies. The project also established ADA's relationship with local schools and orphan caregivers that would support later programs.

2. Widow Vocational Training — Cohort 1 (March–September 2022)

Location: Bamenda | **Beneficiaries:** 15 widows | **Actual Cost:** \$2,917 (1,750,000 CFA)

Our flagship program of 2022 and ADA's most ambitious undertaking to date. Fifteen widows in Bamenda enrolled in a six-month tailoring and dressmaking training program. Participants received sewing machines, fabric, and materials alongside structured instruction. By September, **12 of 15 participants (80%) graduated and began earning income** through their new skills. This program validated ADA's theory of change: that sustainable empowerment comes through skills, not just aid. It also marked our geographic expansion to Bamenda.

3. Widow Support — Food & Financial Aid (March 2022)

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 15 widows | **Actual Cost:** \$767 (460,000 CFA)

Concurrent with the vocational training launch, ADA provided immediate relief to 15 widows in Buea through food packages and direct financial assistance. This program addressed urgent needs — nutrition and household expenses — while our longer-term vocational programs were being established. Each widow received a food basket and a financial grant to cover pressing obligations such as rent, medical bills, or children's school fees.

4. School Visit & Mentorship — May 2022

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 25 orphans | **Actual Cost:** \$275 (165,000 CFA)

ADA volunteers visited schools in Buea to deliver mentorship sessions to 25 orphans. Beyond material support, this program addressed the emotional and developmental needs of children growing up without parents. Volunteers shared life skills, encouraged academic persistence, and provided a caring adult presence. This low-cost, high-impact model demonstrated that meaningful intervention doesn't always require large budgets.

5. IDP Girls Baking Training & Startup Kits — July 2022

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 15 IDP girls | **Actual Cost:** \$1,458 (875,000 CFA)

ADA's first program targeting internally displaced persons (IDPs) — young women displaced by the ongoing Anglophone crisis. Fifteen girls received intensive baking training followed by startup kits containing ovens, baking supplies, and initial ingredients to launch small businesses. This program recognized that displaced young

women face unique vulnerabilities and need economic empowerment to rebuild their lives. The startup kit model ensured participants could immediately apply their training.

6. Back-to-School 2022 — September 2022

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 20 orphans | **Actual Cost:** \$975 (585,000 CFA)

As the new academic year began, ADA provided comprehensive back-to-school packages to 20 orphans. Building on our February distribution, this program included uniforms, shoes, and school fees in addition to supplies — a more holistic intervention addressing the full cost of education. This ensured children could start the year on equal footing with their peers.

7. Christmas Giving 2022 — December 2022

Location: Buea | **Beneficiaries:** 30 (widows & orphans) | **Actual Cost:** \$583 (350,000 CFA)

ADA closed 2022 with our inaugural Christmas campaign, bringing holiday joy to 30 widows and orphans in Buea. Beneficiaries received food packages, clothing, and gifts. Beyond material provision, the event created community — bringing together people who often feel forgotten during the holiday season. This campaign established a tradition we intend to grow annually.

Financial Summary

Overview

Category	Amount (USD)	Amount (CFA)
Total Budget	\$7,700	4,620,000
Total Actual Expenditure	\$7,442	4,465,000
Savings	\$258	155,000
Budget Efficiency	96.7%	—

Expenditure by Project

Project	Budget (USD)	Actual (USD)	Actual (CFA)	% of Total
Widow Vocational Training	\$3,000	\$2,917	1,750,000	39.2%
IDP Baking Training	\$1,500	\$1,458	875,000	19.6%
Back-to-School 2022	\$1,000	\$975	585,000	13.1%
Widow Support (Food & Aid)	\$800	\$767	460,000	10.3%
Christmas Giving	\$600	\$583	350,000	7.8%
School Supply Distribution	\$500	\$467	280,000	6.3%
School Visit & Mentorship	\$300	\$275	165,000	3.7%
TOTAL	\$7,700	\$7,442	4,465,000	100%

Expenditure by Category

Category	Amount (USD)	% of Total
Vocational Training & Skills Development	\$4,375	58.8%
Education Support (Supplies, Fees, Uniforms)	\$1,717	23.1%
Direct Relief (Food, Financial Aid, Gifts)	\$1,350	18.1%
TOTAL	\$7,442	100%

Overhead Analysis

ADA operated with **zero administrative overhead charged to project budgets** in 2022. Project funds were directed to program delivery. This was possible because:

- All team members served as unpaid volunteers
- No office rent was incurred (home-based operations)
- Communication and coordination costs were absorbed personally by leadership
- Transportation to project sites was donated or personally funded

Donor-funded project budgets were used for beneficiary support and direct program delivery.

Fiscal Discipline

Every project came in under budget, with total savings of \$258 (3.3%). This reflects careful procurement, negotiated rates with local suppliers, and a culture of stewardship. Savings were retained for future programming.

Impact by Demographic

Widows — 30 Beneficiaries Served

Program	Beneficiaries	Type of Support
Vocational Training Cohort 1	15	6-month tailoring training
Widow Support (Food & Aid)	15	Food packages + financial grants

Key Outcomes: - 12 widows graduated with income-generating tailoring skills - 15 widows received immediate food and financial relief - Economic independence pathway established for participants

Orphans — 65 Beneficiaries Served

Program	Beneficiaries	Type of Support
School Supply Distribution	20	School supplies & bags
School Visit & Mentorship	25	Mentorship & life skills
Back-to-School 2022	20	Uniforms, fees & supplies

Key Outcomes: - 40 children equipped for school attendance - 25 children received mentorship and emotional support - Education continuity ensured for vulnerable children

Internally Displaced Persons (IDPs) — 15 Beneficiaries Served

Program	Beneficiaries	Type of Support
IDP Girls Baking Training	15	Baking skills + startup kits

Key Outcomes: - 15 displaced young women trained in baking - Each graduate received a startup kit to launch a business - Economic pathway created for crisis-affected youth

Community (Mixed) — 30 Beneficiaries Served

Program	Beneficiaries	Type of Support
Christmas Giving 2022	30	Food, clothing & gifts

Key Outcomes: - 30 widows and orphans celebrated Christmas with dignity - Community bonds strengthened through shared celebration - Annual tradition established for continued engagement

Governance & Team

Board & Leadership

ADA is governed by a lean leadership structure appropriate for our stage of growth:

- **Lionel Tchami Nfada, MSc** — Founder & President (strategic direction, fundraising, international partnerships)
- **Naomi Ndababonga** — Country Director (program delivery, team management, local operations)

Team Growth

Period	Team Size	Capacity
November 2021 (founding)	3 volunteers	Home visits only
December 2022	8+ volunteers	Multi-city program delivery

Growth factor: 2.7x in one year

Volunteer Development

In 2022, ADA invested in volunteer capacity through:

- On-the-job training during project execution
- Mentorship from leadership

- Increasing responsibility with each successive project
- Exposure to multiple program types (education, vocational, relief)

Organizational Development

Key governance milestones in 2022:

- Established project planning and budgeting processes
 - Implemented financial tracking and reporting systems
 - Created beneficiary identification and selection criteria
 - Developed partnerships with local schools and community leaders
 - Opened second operational base in Bamenda
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Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenges

1. Operating in a Crisis Context

The ongoing Anglophone crisis in Cameroon's North-West and South-West regions created security challenges, displaced populations, and economic instability. Program delivery required flexibility and security awareness.

2. Limited Funding Pipeline

As a new organization, ADA relied primarily on personal networks and small individual donations. We lacked institutional funding relationships, limiting our ability to plan multi-year programs.

3. Volunteer Retention & Capacity

While our team grew, managing volunteers without compensation presented challenges. Competing demands on volunteers' time occasionally affected project timelines.

4. Monitoring & Evaluation

With limited resources, our M&E systems were basic. We tracked outputs (beneficiaries reached, items distributed) but lacked robust tools for measuring long-term outcomes.

Lessons Learned

- 1. Vocational training delivers lasting impact.** The 80% graduation rate and income generation from our tailoring cohort confirmed that skills-based programs create sustainable change — not dependency.
 - 2. Start small, prove the model, then scale.** Each project built credibility and capacity for the next. Our February school supply distribution (20 beneficiaries, \$467) gave us confidence to attempt the six-month vocational program (\$2,917).
 - 3. Geographic expansion requires local leadership.** Our Bamenda operations succeeded because we had a trusted local team, not because we managed remotely from Buea.
 - 4. Fiscal discipline builds trust.** Coming in 3.3% under budget across all projects demonstrates stewardship that funders and partners can rely on.
 - 5. Diverse programming reduces risk.** Serving four demographics across multiple program types meant that challenges in one area didn't halt all operations.
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Looking Ahead: 2023 Plans

Building on 2022's foundation, ADA's 2023 strategy focuses on **deepening impact and building sustainability**:

Planned Initiatives

- 1. Vocational Training Cohort 2** — Expand to additional trades (hairdressing, catering) and increase cohort size
- 2. Scholarship Program** — Formalize education support with term-by-term school fee coverage
- 3. Widow Cooperative** — Help vocational graduates form a cooperative for shared resources and market access
- 4. IDP Skills Expansion** — Build on baking training success with additional trades
- 5. Annual Campaigns** — Grow Back-to-School and Christmas campaigns to reach more beneficiaries
- 6. Health Outreach** — Introduce basic health screenings and hygiene education

Organizational Goals

- Secure first institutional/grant funding

- Formalize M&E framework with outcome tracking
- Develop 3-year strategic plan
- Build online presence and digital fundraising capacity
- Register for international partnership eligibility
- Grow team to 12+ volunteers with defined roles

Budget Target: 2023

We aim to double our 2022 expenditure, targeting **\$15,000–\$20,000** in program delivery for 2023, reaching **250+ beneficiaries** across both cities.

How to Support Us

Give

ADA prioritizes direct program delivery and keeps administration lean, with executive coordination handled on a volunteer basis.

- **One-time gifts** of any amount make a difference
- **Monthly giving** of \$25/month sponsors one orphan's education for a year
- **Project sponsorship** — fund an entire program (from \$300–\$3,000)

Volunteer

Join our team in Buea or Bamenda. We need: - Program coordinators - Mentors for orphans and youth - Skills trainers (tailoring, baking, hairdressing) - Communications and fundraising support

Partner

Organizations, churches, and businesses can partner with ADA through: - Program co-funding - In-kind donations (materials, equipment, venue space) - Technical expertise and capacity building - International advocacy and awareness

Spread the Word

Share our story. Follow us on social media. Tell your church, your workplace, your community about ADA's mission.

Contact & Legal Information

Contact Details

Channel	Details
Email	info@apotidev.org
Phone/WhatsApp	+237 676 282 346
Website	www.apotidev.org
Location (HQ)	Buea, South-West Region, Cameroon
Location (Branch)	Bamenda, North-West Region, Cameroon

Legal Registration

- **Organization:** Apoti Development Association (ADA)
- **Registration Number:** N° 415/G.37/D14/Voll/SAAJP
- **Type:** Non-profit association
- **Country:** Republic of Cameroon
- **Year of Registration:** 2021

Accountability

ADA is committed to transparency and accountability. This annual report is published publicly. Financial records are available for review by donors and partners upon request.

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This report covers the period January 1 – December 31, 2022.

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